

Tom J. Wilson

University of Exeter
Physics Building, Stocker Road, Exeter, EX4 4QL
t.j.wilson@exeter.ac.uk / onoddil@pm.me, [ORCID: 0000-0001-6352-9735](#)
[onoddil.github.io](#), [@Onoddil](#) — Updated November 2025

PROFESSIONAL WORK

- Senior Research Fellow*, University of Exeter, 2024-
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, University of Exeter, 2020-2023
- Awarded two STFC grants
 - Creation of software pipeline for cross-matching external photometric catalogues to LSST datasets as part of LSST:UK consortium, writing tens of thousands of lines of code across multiple programming languages
 - Efficient analysis of datasets of 10s of billions of objects, ensuring statistical robustness, correcting for systematic effects and correlations
 - Working within the Vera C. Rubin Observatory commissioning team on verifying and validating telescope astrometry, and ensuring that astrometric uncertainties produced by the LSST pipeline match observations
- Postdoctoral Researcher*, Space Telescope Science Institute, 2018-2019
- STScI Director's Discretionary Research Fund
- Software development for `photutils`, an `astropy`-affiliated python package, focussing on analysis tools for PSF photometry
 - Developed optimised observing strategy for NASA's \$3 billion flagship spacecraft, the *Roman* Space Telescope
 - Involved solving maximisation problem of information content analysis, and robust statistical analysis of the fitting and modelling of supernovae lightcurves
 - Differential analysis of wide-field *Hubble* datasets, improving search efficiency of transient events

EDUCATION

- PhD in Physics*, University of Exeter, 2013-2018 — Supervisor: Prof. Tim Naylor
- Awarded STFC PhD Studentship
- Developed modern statistical methods for solving catalogue cross-matching problem in astronomy, optimised for datasets of billions of objects
 - Complex characterisation of datasets in various correlated parameters, allowing for quantitative comparisons across independent datasets
- Master's Dissertation*, University of Exeter, 2012-2013 — Supervisor: Prof. Tim Naylor
- Analysis of datasets for previously unexplored parameterisations of data in colour-magnitude diagrams to enable new solutions for outstanding problems
 - Exploration of parameter phase space and determination of key impacting factors in the initial mass function of stellar clusters
 - Developed novel analysis tools to disentangle correlated parameters, resolving degeneracies within multi-dimensional datasets, breaking degeneracies with age in colour-colour diagrams
- College Summer Internship*, University of Exeter, 2012 — Supervisor: Dr Jennifer Hatchell
- Awarded University College Studentship
- Work on the construction of temperature and dust β maps from JCMT 450 μ m and 850 μ m observations, supplementing existing datasets with new data and updated analysis methodology
- MPhys in Physics with Astrophysics*, First Class Honours, University of Exeter, 2009-2013

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

- Developer for the `astropy photutils` package
- 8th highest contribution (2nd highest 2018-2020) to the community-driven, open source software
 - Code tests, feature improvements, package maintenance, and documentation development
- Lead developer of the `macauff` python package
- Development of computationally efficient and precise codebase to ensure accurate photometry and astrometry can be obtained for a set of cross-matched photometric catalogues
 - Writing entire project end-to-end, including creation of continuous integration suite, documentation, and class-based python and fortran code
- Other project highlights:
- Optimisation and efficiency strategy for *Roman* Space Telescope's supernovae survey, impacting two years of flagship space telescope observations
 - Improvements to data reduction for JCMT observations, and writing of key data analysis pipeline
- Main programming strengths: python (`astropy`), fortran (`openmp`), statistical analysis and application

GRANTS AND AWARDS	2023, LINCC Frameworks Incubator Program, “Integrating Robust Cross-Matching from the LSST:UK into the LINCC Framework”, \$20,000 2023-2027, Co-PI STFC Grant, “UK Involvement in LSST: Phase C (Exeter Component)”, £510,000 2022, “Above and Beyond” Award, University of Exeter – extending second-year astrophysics lab experiments and converting from IRAF to Python 2019-2023, Co-writer and lead researcher STFC Grant, “UK Involvement in LSST: Phase B (Exeter Component)”, £440,000
FIRST-AUTHOR PUBLICATIONS	Wilson, Tom J., Naylor T., 2025, LSST SITCOMTN-159; Determining the Accuracy and Precision of Astrometric Positions and Covariances from the LSST Science Pipelines Using Rubin’s Operations Rehearsal 3 Data Wilson Tom J., 2023, RASTI, 2, 1; “Overcoming Separation Between Counterparts Due to Unknown Proper Motions in Catalogue Cross-Matching” Wilson Tom J., 2022, RNAAS, 6, 60; “A Parameterized Model for Differential Galaxy Counts at Any Wavelength” Wilson Tom J., 2021, RNAAS, 5, 265; “On the Use of Evidence and Goodness-of-Fit Metrics in Exoplanet Atmosphere Interpretation” Wilson Tom J., Naylor T., 2018, MNRAS, 481, 2148; “A Contaminant-Free Catalogue of <i>Gaia</i> DR2-<i>WISE</i> Galactic Plane Matches: Including the Effects of Crowding in the Cross-Matching of Photometric Catalogues” Wilson Tom J., Naylor T., 2018, MNRAS, 473, 5570; “Improving Catalogue Matching By Supplementing Astrometry with Additional Photometric Information” Wilson Tom J., Naylor T., 2017, MNRAS, 468, 2517; “The Effect of Unresolved Contaminant Stars on the Cross-matching of Photometric Catalogues”
CO-AUTHOR PUBLICATIONS	Wilson A. J., Lakeland B. S., Wilson T. J., Naylor T., 2023, MNRAS, 521, 354; “A Naive Bayes Classifier for identifying Class II YSOs” Astropy Collaboration, ..., Wilson T. J., et al., 2022, ApJ, 935, 167; “The Astropy Project: Sustaining and Growing a Community-oriented Open-source Project and the Latest Major Release (v5.0) of the Core Package” Bruno G., Lewis N. K., Valenti J. A., Pagano I., Wilson T. J., et al., 2022, MNRAS, 509, 5030; “Hiding in Plain Sight: Observing Planet-Starspot Crossings with the <i>James Webb Space Telescope</i>” Bradley L., Sipőcz B., Robitaille T., Tollerud E., Vinícius Z., Deil C., Barbary K., Wilson T. J., et al., 2019-2022, 10.5281/zenodo.7419741; “astropy/photutils: v0.6 through v1.6.0” Lewis N. K., ..., Wilson T. J., et al., 2020, ApJL, 902, 19; “Into the UV: The Atmosphere of the Hot Jupiter HAT-P-41b Revealed” Wakeford H. R., Sing D. K., Stevenson K. B., Lewis N. K., Pirzkal N., Wilson T. J., et al., 2020, AJ, 159, 204; “Into the UV: A Precise Transmission Spectrum of HAT-P-41b Using Hubble’s WFC3/UVIS G280 Grism” Steinhardt C., ..., Wilson T. J., et al., 2020, ApJS, 247, 64; “The Buffalo HST Survey” Wakeford H. R., Wilson T. J., et al., 2019, RNAAS, 3, 7; “Exoplanet Atmosphere Forecast: Observers Should Expect Spectroscopic Transmission Features to be Muted to 33%” Wakeford H. R., Lewis N. K., Fowler J., Bruno G., Wilson T. J., et al., 2019, AJ, 157, 11; “Disentangling the Planet from the Star in Late-Type M Dwarfs: A Case Study of TRAPPIST-1g” Wakeford H. R., Sing D. K., Deming D., Lewis N. K., Goyal J., Wilson T. J., et al., 2018, AJ, 155, 29; “The Complete Transmission Spectrum of WASP-39b with a Precise Water Constraint” Rumble D., Hatchell J., Pattle K., Kirk H., Wilson T., et al., 2016, MNRAS, 460, 4150; “The JCMT Gould Belt Survey: Evidence for Radiative Heating and Contamination in the W40 Complex” Rees J., Wilson T., et al., 2016, IAUS, 314, 205; “The Age of Taurus: Environmental Effects on Disc Lifetimes” Hatchell J., Wilson T., et al., 2013, MNRAS, 429, 10; “The JCMT Gould Belt Survey: SCUBA-2 Observations of Radiative Feedback in NGC 1333”
SCIENTIFIC TALKS & CONFERENCES	7 invited seminars, 8 invited conference talks, 4 contributed seminars, 24 contributed conference talks, 5 contributed conference posters. July 2025, ADASSx 2025, Invited Talk July 2025, Rubin Community Workshop 2025, Image Quality, Contributed Talk July 2025, Rubin Community Workshop 2025, IKCs and IDACs, Invited Talk October 2024, SMWLVS Science Collaboration, Invited Talk October 2024, Southampton, Invited Seminar

September 2024, LSST@Europe6, Contributed Talk
 July 2024, Rubin Community Workshop 2024, LSST Science Collaborations Plenary, Invited Talk
 July 2024, Rubin Community Workshop 2024, Stellar Science and Crowded Fields, Contributed Talk
 July 2024, National Astronomy Meeting 2024, Invited Talk
 March 2024, LINCC Tech Talk Series, Invited Talk
 January 2024, Rubin Solar Neighborhood Ultracool Dwarfs Meeting, Contributed Talk
 October 2023, LSST@Europe 5, Contributed Talk
 August 2023, Rubin Project and Community Workshop 2023, Contributed Talk
 July 2023, National Astronomy Meeting 2023, UK Involvement in LSST, Contributed Talk
 July 2023, National Astronomy Meeting 2023, 10 years after Herschel, Contributed Talk
 July 2023, National Astronomy Meeting 2023, Euclid exploitation in the UK, Contributed Talk
 March 2023, 3rd TVS Software Workshop, Invited Talk
 October 2022, LSST@Europe4, Contributed Talk
 July 2022, National Astronomy Meeting 2022, Contributed Talk
 July 2022, Cool Stars 21, Contributed Poster
 June 2022, Asteroseismology MW-Gaia Workshop, Contributed Talk
 June 2022, Bristol-Cardiff Joint Seminar Series, Invited Seminar
 May 2022, Carnegie EPL, Invited Seminar
 February 2022, University of Delaware, Invited Seminar
 August 2021, Rubin Observatory Project and Community Workshop, Contributed Talk
 July 2021, National Astronomy Meeting 2021, Contributed Talk
 July 2021, National Astronomy Meeting 2021, Invited Talk
 June 2021, Statistical Challenges in Modern Astronomy VII, Contributed Poster
 May 2021, LSST:UK All-Hands Meeting, Invited Talk
 May 2021, LSST:UK All-Hands Meeting, Contributed Talk
 April 2021, UKEXOM 2021, Contributed Talk
 April 2021, University of Exeter, Contributed Seminar
 March 2021, Cool Stars 20.5, Contributed Poster
 October 2020, RAS Specialist Meeting: TVS with Rubin Observatory, Contributed Talk
 August 2020, Rubin Observatory Project and Community Workshop, Contributed Talk
 July 2020, University of Exeter, Contributed Seminar
 July 2019, Python in Astronomy 19, Contributed Talk
 June 2019, STScI, HotSci@STScI Colloquia, Contributed Seminar
 March 2019, STScI, Friday Science Coffee, Contributed Seminar
 February 2019, STScI, TESS Data Workshop, Contributed Talk
 February 2019, UNLV BUFFALO 2019 Meeting, Contributed Talk
 May 2018, Exeter, First Year PhD Development Day, Invited Seminar
 March 2018, Science with Precision Astrometry, Contributed Poster
 September 2017, Cardiff Star Formation Workshop, Contributed Talk
 July 2016, NASA Goddard Space Flight Center, Invited Seminar
 June 2016, Cool Stars 19, Contributed Poster
 April 2015, BECSS Bristol, Contributed Talk
 March 2015, Milky Way Astrophysics from Wide-Field Surveys, Contributed Talk

COMMITTEE & SERVICE

August 2023, Rubin Project and Community Workshop 2023 Crowded Fields Session, Science Organising Committee
 May 2021, LSST:UK All-Hands Meeting, Local Organising Committee
 June 2019, Hubble Support Scientist for Cycle 29 Time Allocation Committee
 Peer review referee for AAS Journals and JOSS
 Co-Chair of LSST:UK Junior Associate Network, 2025-
 Co-Chair of LSST Stars, Milky Way and Local Volume Science Collaboration (SMWLVS), 2025-
 Member of LSST:UK Exec Group, Junior Associate Network Representative, 2024-
 Member of LSST:UK Communications Steering Group, 2025-
 Member of LSST SMWLVS Crowded Stellar Field Task Force, 2022-
 Member of Vera C. Rubin Observatory SIT-Com Commissioning team (Astrometric and Crowded Field Science Units), 2022-

TEACHING & OUTREACH EXPERIENCE

Astrophysics Lab Re-Write Lead, 2021-

- Spearhead updating of second year astrophysics lab course content
- Involves translating materials from IRAF to Python

- Update pedagogy to ensure that students are engaging with the material in the most effective way
- Review course aims and opportunities for students to practice experimental analysis and programming skills developed in complementary modules

Undergraduate Astrophysics Lab Demonstrator, 2013-2022

- Assist in teaching of 20-30 second year undergraduates in the astrophysics portion of the lab
- Demonstrated use of UNIX commands, IRAF and Python, data reduction and analysis, & report writing
- Duties included report assessment and feedback
- Experiments included analysis of Cepheid variability periods, colour-magnitude diagrams, and optical spectroscopy

Undergraduate Python Demonstrator, 2021

- Teaching Python to approximately 30 second year undergraduates
- Demonstrating key Python and general programming skills, logical thinking, and problem solving
- Includes live assistance, technical support, and formal work marking and feedback

Undergraduate Astrophysics Teaching Telescope Operator, 2013-2017

- Lead undergraduate students in usage of the university's teaching telescope
- Teaching of telescope operation, as well as remote/automated capacities of ACP Scheduler
- Involved teaching an understanding of observation planning

Undergraduate Physics Problem Tutor, 2013-2017

- Assist in running first year undergraduate physics problems classes
- Involved organising homework sessions, managing approximately 140 students
- Provided guidance on a wide variety of problems, ranging from solid state physics to electromagnetism to astrophysics

"Pint of Science" Event Organiser, 2013-2018

- Co-organised the "Pint of Science" outreach events held in Exeter each year
- Events involve three nights of outreach talks from a selection of researchers, aimed at public engagement
- Included a host of responsibilities including deciding the themes for each nights' talks, inviting speakers, and organising event location
- Involved engaging with the community and answering questions from members of the public

Observing At the James Clerk Maxwell Telescope, Hawaii, 2014

- Experience at the JCMT as part of the JPS survey
- Involved telescope operation, data processing, and observation scheduling